



PODMORE MEDIA

Getting Started Guide

Facebook Page, Google Business Profile
and Email Marketing Setup

Build the foundations of a stronger local presence

A practical step-by-step handbook for UK local service businesses.

Set up the accounts properly, understand why they matter and create a simple system you can keep using.

Clear instructions • Practical checklists • No marketing jargon

Welcome

You do not need dozens of marketing tools to give your business a solid online foundation. For most local service businesses, three simple assets cover the basics: a Facebook Page, a Google Business Profile and a straightforward email list.

Each one has a different job. Facebook helps your business look active and familiar. Google Business Profile helps nearby customers find and assess you. Email helps you stay in touch with people who already know your business.

This guide takes you through the setup in plain English. Complete it in one sitting, or follow the seven-day plan near the end.

What you will achieve

Create or improve a professional Facebook Page.
Create, claim and complete a Google Business Profile.
Set up an AWeber list and a simple way for people to subscribe.
Understand how the three systems support each other.
Avoid common setup, trust and compliance mistakes.

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1. Before you begin

Gathering the right information first will make the setup faster and help your business look consistent everywhere.

Business details to prepare

- ☐ Your exact trading name, written the same way you use it publicly.
- ☐ Main telephone number and business email address.
- ☐ Website address, if you have one.
- ☐ Opening hours and emergency or out-of-hours availability.
- ☐ A list of your main services.
- ☐ The towns, boroughs or postcodes you genuinely serve.
- ☐ A short description of the business and what customers can expect.

Images to prepare

- ☐ A clear logo or professional head-and-shoulders photo.
- ☐ A wide cover image, such as your van, team or a strong completed job.
- ☐ Several genuine work photos.
- ☐ Before-and-after images where suitable and with customer permission.

Accounts and access

- ☐ A personal Facebook account that you control.
- ☐ A Google account you intend to keep as the long-term owner of the Business Profile.
- ☐ An AWeber account, or the ability to create one.
- ☐ Access to your website, or the contact details of the person who manages it.

Consistency matters

Use the same business name, phone number, website and core service details across Facebook, Google and your website.

Small inconsistencies can confuse customers and make future account management harder.

2. Facebook Business Page

A Facebook Page gives your business a public home on Facebook. It is separate from your personal profile, although a real Facebook account is needed to create or manage it.

Why it matters

Customers often check Facebook to see whether a business appears active, local and genuine. Your Page can display contact details, services, photos, updates and a clear action button.

Step 1: Create the Page

1. Sign in to the Facebook account that will manage the business Page.
2. Open Facebook Pages and choose the option to create a new Page.
3. Enter your real business or trading name.
4. Choose the closest accurate business category.
5. Add a short description explaining what you do and where you work.
6. Create the Page and follow the on-screen prompts.

Choosing the Page name

- Use the name customers already recognise.
- Do not fill the name with extra towns, services or marketing claims.
- Avoid claims such as 'best' or 'number one' unless genuinely verifiable and part of the trading name.

Step 2: Add the essentials

- ☐ Profile image: usually your logo or a clear professional photo.
- ☐ Cover image: a van, team image or strong completed job.
- ☐ Telephone number and business email.
- ☐ Website address.
- ☐ Opening hours.
- ☐ Service area or location details.
- ☐ A concise About description.

Facebook Page: make it useful

Step 3: Set the action button

Choose the most useful next step for customers. Depending on the options shown, this might be Call now, Send message, WhatsApp, Get quote or Visit website.

Keep it realistic

Only use a booking option if the booking process is genuinely available and monitored.
If calls are your main source of work, a clear call button may be the simplest choice.

Step 4: Add services and trust details

- List your main services using plain customer language.
- Mention the areas you serve.
- Add genuine qualifications, memberships or guarantees only where accurate.
- Use real photographs rather than generic stock images where possible.
- Check how the Page looks on a mobile phone.

Step 5: Publish your first three posts

Post	Suggested content
1. Introduction	Who you are, what you do and the areas you serve.
2. Helpful tip	A practical homeowner tip connected to a common problem.
3. Trust builder	A genuine job photo, customer comment or explanation of how you work.

Facebook Page checklist

- ☐ The Page name and category are accurate.
- ☐ Contact details work.
- ☐ Profile and cover images display clearly.
- ☐ The About section explains services and location.
- ☐ The action button leads somewhere useful.
- ☐ At least three useful posts are visible.
- ☐ A trusted backup person has the appropriate Facebook access if needed.

Common mistakes

- Creating a second personal profile instead of a business Page.
- Leaving old telephone numbers or opening hours visible.
- Posting only sales messages.
- Using fake awards, vague claims or photographs that do not represent the business.
- Giving full control to people who do not need it.

3. Google Business Profile

Google Business Profile is one of the most important free tools for a local service business. It helps the business appear on Google Search and Maps and gives customers key information before they call.

A strong profile can show

Business name, phone number, website and hours.

Services and service areas.

Photographs and updates.

Customer reviews and your responses.

Check eligibility first

A business normally needs to make in-person contact with customers. Trades and home-service companies that travel to customers are generally treated as service-area businesses.

Important for home-based trades

If customers do not visit your address, do not display it as a public shopfront.

Use the service-area business setup and show only the areas you genuinely serve.

Step 1: Add or claim the profile

1. Sign in to the Google account that should own the profile long term.
2. Go to Google Business Profile and search for the business.
3. If the profile exists, follow the claim or ownership-request process.
4. If it does not exist, choose the option to add the business.
5. Enter the real trading name exactly as customers know it.
6. Choose the most accurate primary category.

Categories

- Choose the category that best describes the main service.
- Add relevant secondary categories only where they genuinely apply.
- Do not create false categories or keyword-filled business names.

Google Business Profile: location and verification

Step 2: Choose the correct business type

Business type	Use this when
Shopfront	Customers visit and are served at a staffed business location with permanent signage.
Service-area business	You travel to customers and do not serve them at your address.
Hybrid	You serve customers at a location and also travel to them.

Step 3: Set service areas

- Add cities, boroughs or postcodes you genuinely cover.
- Google allows multiple service areas, but do not list places you cannot realistically serve.
- Keep service areas focused rather than trying to cover the whole country.
- Review them whenever your coverage changes.

Step 4: Complete verification

Google decides which verification methods are available. These can include video recording, phone, email, postcard, live video or other methods. Follow the method shown inside your profile.

Prepare before video verification

Have your branded van, tools, invoices, work clothing, business documents or other proof ready. For a service-area business, be ready to show that the business exists and that you manage it. Do not share verification codes with anyone.

If somebody else owns the profile

Use Google's ownership-request process. Do not create a duplicate profile simply because access is difficult. Duplicates can create confusion and suspension risk.

Google Business Profile: complete the profile

Step 5: Add complete business information

- ☐ Accurate business name.
- ☐ Primary and relevant secondary categories.
- ☐ Telephone number customers can reach.
- ☐ Website address.
- ☐ Opening hours and any special hours.
- ☐ Service areas.
- ☐ Main services.
- ☐ A clear business description.

Writing the business description

Explain what the business does, who it helps and where it works. Use natural language. Do not fill the description with repeated town names or exaggerated claims.

Simple description structure

Who you are.

Your main services.

The areas you cover.

What customers can expect.

A practical next step.

Step 6: Add services

- Use individual service names customers understand.
- Add useful descriptions where available.
- Keep prices accurate if you choose to display them.
- Review the list whenever services change.

Step 7: Add strong photographs

- Logo and cover image.
- Branded van or vehicle.
- Team or owner photographs.
- Completed jobs and before-and-after images.
- Tools, workshop or genuine behind-the-scenes photographs.
- Avoid adding customer details, addresses or faces without permission.

Google Business Profile: reviews and updates

Step 8: Find your Google review link

7. Sign in to the Google account that manages the Business Profile.
8. Search Google for your business name or open the profile.
9. Choose the option to read or manage reviews.
10. Select Get more reviews.
11. Copy the direct review link and save it somewhere easy to access.

Use that link in your review request template, text messages, emails and printed material where appropriate.

Ask correctly

Ask genuine customers for honest feedback.

Do not offer rewards for positive reviews.

Do not pressure customers or ask only people you know will leave five stars.

Respond calmly and professionally to both positive and negative reviews.

Step 9: Publish useful updates

- Helpful seasonal advice.
- Service reminders.
- A completed job or project explanation.
- New services or availability changes.
- A genuine customer question and useful answer.

Monthly maintenance checklist

- ☐ Check phone number, website, hours and service areas.
- ☐ Add recent photographs.
- ☐ Publish useful updates.
- ☐ Respond to new reviews.
- ☐ Review services and descriptions.
- ☐ Check for unexpected edits or incorrect public information.

Common mistakes

- Using a virtual office or address where the business does not genuinely operate.
- Creating duplicate profiles.
- Adding fake locations.
- Keyword stuffing the business name.
- Ignoring reviews or leaving incorrect hours visible.

4. Email marketing with AWeber

Email helps you stay in touch with customers who already know your business. It can support repeat work, seasonal reminders, referrals and useful updates without relying entirely on social media.

Keep the purpose simple

Do not add people to marketing emails simply because you have their address. For individual subscribers, use valid consent or make sure every requirement of the PECR soft opt-in is met.

Make every email useful, recognisable and easy to unsubscribe from.

Step 1: Create the account

1. Go to aweber.com and choose the current account option that suits the business.
2. Use a business-controlled email address.
3. Enter the correct business details and postal address.
4. Check the current plan limits before importing contacts or building automations.

AWeber plans, prices and limits can change. Use AWeber's current pricing page rather than relying on old limits.

Step 2: Create the first list

5. Open the list area in the AWeber dashboard.
6. Create a list with a clear internal name, such as ABC Plumbing Customers.
7. Choose a recognisable sender name.
8. Use a reply address that somebody monitors.
9. Write a short explanation of what subscribers will receive.
10. Review the confirmation and unsubscribe settings.

What subscribers might receive

- Seasonal maintenance reminders.
- Useful homeowner tips.
- Service updates.
- Occasional offers.
- Helpful follow-up after completed work.

AWeber: build the list properly

Step 3: Create a sign-up route

AWeber can provide forms and landing pages. The exact menu labels may change, but the aim is the same: give people a clear place to knowingly join your list.

11. Open the Landing Pages or Sign Up Forms area.
12. Create a simple sign-up form or landing page.
13. Ask only for information you genuinely need.
14. Explain what the person is signing up to receive.
15. Add the business name and privacy wording.
16. Test the form yourself before sharing it.

Good places to share the sign-up link

- The business website.
- Facebook Page.
- Email signature.
- Invoices or aftercare messages where appropriate.
- A useful downloadable checklist or guide.

Step 4: Add subscribers lawfully

Do not upload the whole customer database automatically

A customer who paid for a job has not necessarily agreed to ongoing marketing.

Use valid consent, or make sure you can demonstrate that every requirement of the PECR soft opt-in is met.

Keep evidence of how people joined the list.

- Do not buy email lists.
- Do not use guessed addresses.
- Do not hide marketing consent inside unrelated wording.
- Respect unsubscribes immediately.
- Seek professional advice where you are unsure about UK GDPR or PECR.

Confirmed opt-in

AWeber offers confirmed opt-in settings. Confirmation can improve list quality, although the available settings can differ depending on how the subscriber is added. Review the current settings for forms, manual additions, imports and integrations.

AWeber: send the first email

Step 5: Create a welcome email

A simple welcome email reassures the subscriber that the sign-up worked and sets expectations.

Section	What to include
Greeting	Use the person's first name where available.
Thank you	Confirm why they are receiving the email.
Expectation	Explain what you will send and how often.
Useful first step	Give one practical tip, link or resource.
Contact	Provide a monitored reply address.
Unsubscribe	Keep AWeber's required unsubscribe link visible.

Step 6: Send a broadcast

17. Open the Messages or Broadcasts area.
18. Create a new broadcast.
19. Add the approved subject line and email content.
20. Check every link.
21. Send a test to yourself.
22. Check it on both desktop and mobile.
23. Send only when the content and recipient list are correct.

Useful email ideas

- Winter pipe and boiler reminders.
- When to call a professional rather than attempt a repair.
- Simple maintenance tips.
- New service announcements.
- Answers to common customer questions.
- Occasional offers that are genuine and clearly explained.

A useful rule of thumb

Most emails should be helpful rather than promotional.

Write like a trusted local business, not a faceless marketing company.

5. How the three systems work together

The three platforms are most useful when they support one another rather than operating as isolated accounts.

Platform	Main job
Google Business Profile	Helps nearby customers discover, assess and contact the business.
Facebook Page	Helps the business look active, familiar and connected to the local area.
AWeber	Helps the business stay in touch with people who have chosen to hear from it.

A simple customer journey

1. A homeowner finds the business through Google.
2. They check the website or Facebook Page for reassurance.
3. They call, request a quote or book the service.
4. After the job, they may be invited to leave an honest review.
5. They can separately choose to join the email list for useful updates.
6. Future emails help the business remain familiar when another need arises.

This is the foundation, not the whole strategy

These accounts do not guarantee enquiries.

They work best when the information is accurate, the content is useful and the business follows up professionally.

Keep ownership under control

- The business owner should retain primary ownership of important accounts.
- Use individual access permissions instead of sharing passwords.
- Remove access promptly when staff or suppliers no longer need it.
- Use strong passwords and two-step verification.

6. Seven-day setup plan

Day	Action
Day 1	Gather business details, services, photographs and account access.
Day 2	Create or improve the Facebook Page.
Day 3	Finish Facebook details and publish the first three posts.
Day 4	Create or claim the Google Business Profile.
Day 5	Complete the profile, prepare verification and add services and photographs.
Day 6	Create the AWeber account, list and sign-up route.
Day 7	Test all links, send a test email and complete the master checklist.

Do not rush verification

Facebook and AWeber setup can usually be completed quickly. Google verification may take longer and the available method is decided by Google. Prepare carefully and follow the instructions shown in the profile.

What to do if a platform looks different

- Look for the same function under a new menu name.
- Use the platform's official help centre.
- Do not follow old videos blindly if the interface has changed.
- Take a screenshot before making a major account change.
- Ask for help before creating duplicate profiles or deleting anything.

7. Final master checklist

Facebook

- ☐ Correct Page name and category.
- ☐ Working phone number, email and website.
- ☐ Profile and cover images.
- ☐ About section and service information.
- ☐ Useful action button.
- ☐ At least three helpful posts.
- ☐ Access and security reviewed.

Google Business Profile

- ☐ Correct owner account.
- ☐ Accurate trading name and categories.
- ☐ Correct service-area or shopfront setup.
- ☐ Verification completed or in progress.
- ☐ Phone, website, hours and service areas checked.
- ☐ Services and business description added.
- ☐ Genuine photographs added.
- ☐ Direct review link saved.

AWeber

- ☐ Business-controlled account and sender details.
- ☐ Correct postal and reply details.
- ☐ List created and purpose explained.
- ☐ Sign-up form or landing page tested.
- ☐ Consent and subscriber source considered.
- ☐ Welcome email tested.
- ☐ Unsubscribe route working.

8. What happens next

Once these three foundations are in place, Podmore Media can prepare monthly content and marketing assets for you to review, personalise where needed and use in your business.

Starter Package

- 4 finished social media posts each month.
- 2 finished Google Business Profile posts each month.
- 1 Monthly Content Game Plan.

Growth Package

- 8 finished social media posts each month.
- 4 finished Google Business Profile posts each month.
- 2 finished SEO blog posts each month, approximately 1,000 words each and ready for you to review and publish.
- 1 Website Copy Improvement each month.
- 2 finished email or newsletter drafts each month.
- 1 Monthly Content Game Plan.

Pro Package

- 16 finished social media posts each month.
- 8 finished Google Business Profile posts each month.
- 4 finished SEO blog posts each month, approximately 1,000 words each and ready for you to review and publish.
- 2 Website Copy Improvements each month.
- 4 finished email or newsletter drafts each month.
- 1 monthly review campaign.
- 1 monthly reporting summary.
- 1 Monthly Content Game Plan.

Important

Podmore Media prepares finished content and marketing assets for the customer to review and use. Publishing, account management and ongoing consultancy are not included unless separately agreed.

Questions?

Contact Podmore Media at hello@podmoremedia.com

9. Disclaimer and official help links

This guide provides general information and practical setup support. Platform menus, prices, policies, limits and verification processes can change without notice. Always follow the current instructions shown inside the platform.

This guide does not replace professional legal, compliance, tax or data-protection advice. You remain responsible for checking that customer communications, email marketing, advertising and data handling comply with the rules that apply to your business.

Podmore Media may receive a small commission if you create an AWeber account using the link in this guide, at no extra cost to you.

Official help resources

Resource	Use it for
Meta Business Help Centre	Facebook Page creation, access and account-management guidance.
Google Business Profile Help	Adding, claiming, verifying and managing a Business Profile.
Google Business Profile Guidelines	Eligibility, service-area businesses, addresses and naming rules.
AWeber Knowledge Base	Lists, forms, imports, confirmed opt-in and subscriber management.

For current platform instructions, search the official help centre using the exact task you are trying to complete.

Final reminder

Set up the basics properly, keep the information accurate and take one useful action each week. A simple system that is maintained is more valuable than a complicated system that is ignored.